Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/thomas-j-huntley (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Strategic Partnerships
Financial Modeling
Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Certifications

Top Secret/Sensitive Compartmented Information Security Clearance
Science, Technology, and Environmental Policy Certificate
Airline Transport Pilot

Tom Huntley

General Manager @ REGENT Defense & VP of Government Relations @ REGENT | Princeton MPP | NYU Stern MBA | Presidential Leadership Scholar | USCG (ret) | X = @tomjhuntley; Free Substack = @tomhuntley
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Summary

I operate at the intersection of defense technology, national policy, regulatory systems, and technology development, translating strategic intent into executable programs that scale real capability.

I am currently General Manager of REGENT Defense, where I lead business operations, engineering development, international engagement, and contract capture for advanced dual-use maritime systems.

My work sits at the nexus of defense acquisition, emerging technology, and geopolitics, engaging senior stakeholders across the Department of Defense, Congress, the Executive Branch, and allied Ministries of Defense including the UAE, Japan, the UK, the Philippines, Thailand, and New Zealand. I hold full P&L responsibility, oversee advanced defense engineering efforts, and have captured and executed OTA-based contracts supporting future Programs of Record.

Simultaneously, I serve as Vice President of Government Relations at REGENT, where I built the regulatory and legislative foundation for an entirely new transportation modality, building trust with regulators across a new technology. This included drafting and passing statutory language in authorization and appropriations bills, structuring binding FAA–USCG interagency agreements, enabling international certification pathways, and supporting more than $150M in venture capital fundraising. Internationally, I helped unlock a multi-billion-dollar sales backlog and negotiated an international joint venture supporting manufacturing and market expansion.

Previously, I served on the House Appropriations Committee overseeing major DHS components and nearly $80B in annual

funding. I managed the full appropriations lifecycle, negotiated funding outcomes, authored legislative language, and conducted procurement oversight across cybersecurity, maritime acquisition, border technology, and infrastructure security. Earlier, as a U.S. Coast Guard shipbuilding budget director and program reviewer, I oversaw $1B+ annually across major naval acquisition programs and contributed to the U.S. National Strategy for the Arctic Region.

My foundation is as a U.S. Coast Guard helicopter pilot and operational leader, with nearly two decades of service including search and rescue, Arctic operations, safety and accident investigation, and command-level leadership. I have flown more than 4,000 hours, instructed hundreds of pilots, and led teams responsible for saving over 100 lives.

I specialize in scaling dual-use and defense technology through policy, acquisition, and partnerships—and in delivering operational impact at national scale.

Experience

REGENT

2 years 11 months

General Manager of REGENT Defense and VP of Government Relations at REGENT

July 2025 - Present (1 year)

Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Leads REGENT Defense as General Manager with full P&L accountability, developing and executing go-to-market strategy for next-generation seaglider technology across U.S. Department of Defense, Department of Homeland Security, and allied nations. Oversee integrated business operations spanning business development, customer relations, engineering and capability development, systems integration, contract execution, and internal/external communications.

Built REGENT Defense from concept to contract capture, securing $15M in initial R&D awards with $50M pipeline. Spearheaded international defense partnerships with UK MOD, UAE Armed Forces, Japan Self-Defense Forces,

New Zealand MOD, and Royal Australian Navy, positioning seagliders as transformational capability for contested logistics and expeditionary operations.

As VP of Gov Relations, architects comprehensive engagement strategy across all levels of government. Navigates Congressional authorization and appropriations processes, Executive Branch stakeholder management, defense acquisition pathways, and diverse funding mechanisms. Successfully managed three legislative initiatives resulting in statutory language adoption and direct funding. Built US certification and regulatory framework through authorization language, political coalition development, and legal precedent

Cultivates ecosystem across federal, state, local, tribal, and territorial partnerships. Leads complex international negotiations on certification pathways, technology transfer frameworks, and co-development initiatives. Finalized landmark JV in UAE, establishing model for international partnerships in dual-use maritime technology. Drive coalition-building efforts with IMO and flag states including UAE and Japan.
Bridge strategic vision with operational execution, translating emerging operational concepts into fielded capabilities that address critical gaps in maritime mobility, contested logistics, and power projection.

Vice President of Government Relations & Defense
August 2023 - July 2025 (2 years)
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Leads comprehensive government affairs strategy for REGENT, pioneering regulatory pathways and stakeholder engagement for seaglider technology—a transformational maritime platform operating as a traditional boat, at speed on hydrofoils, and in flight as a wing-in-ground-effect craft.

Architects and executes multi-dimensional engagement across federal, state, local, tribal, territorial, and international governments to accelerate technology adoption and establish enabling policy frameworks. Navigates complex Congressional authorization and appropriations processes, cultivating bipartisan support for seaglider capabilities addressing contested maritime logistics and expeditionary operations.

Manages Executive Branch relations across Department of Defense, Department of Homeland Security, Department of Transportation, and FAA to develop certification pathways for novel technology category. Coordinates

with USCG, MARAD, and federal maritime authorities to establish regulatory precedents for hybrid maritime-aviation systems.
Orchestrates international government relations spanning allied and partner nations.

Leads certification pathway negotiations with International Maritime Organization (IMO) and flag states including UAE, Japan, and others to establish global standards for wing-in-ground-effect craft. Spearheaded government engagement resulting in Joint Venture partnership in UAE, demonstrating model for international technology collaboration.
Develops state and local government strategies focused on economic development incentives, infrastructure partnerships, and ecosystem building to support seaglider manufacturing, testing, and operational deployment.

Translates complex emerging technology capabilities into compelling value propositions for diverse government stakeholders, bridging innovation with policy to enable first-of-its-kind regulatory frameworks that balance safety, security, and operational effectiveness

U.S. House of Representatives
U.S. House Appropriations Committee Staff
January 2022 - June 2023 (1 year 6 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Oversaw and allocated $80B annual Congressional appropriation to DHS.

Detailed to the Homeland Security Appropriations subcommittee staff.
Conducts congressional oversight of all component agencies of DHS, including TSA, CBP, CISA, FEMA, U.S. Secret Service, Coast Guard, and others.
Responsible for allocating annual funding of over $80 billion.

U.S. Coast Guard
Shipbuilding Budget and Program Reviewer
May 2020 - January 2022 (1 year 9 months)

Directly responsible for $1.5B PCI shipbuilding budget, program management/ oversight across six programs.

Commander (O5). Program Reviewer (CG-821) with budgetary oversight across the Coast Guard’s major surface acquisition programs totaling $1.6B in annual appropriations. Programs include Polar Security Cutter, National

Security Cutter, Offshore Patrol Cutter, Fast Response Cutter, and Waterways Commerce Cutter.

Reviewed and approved all program documentation, external communication, and budget support material. Defended resource requests to senior leadership in the Coast Guard, DHS, OMB, and Congress. Secured 4.6% increase in PC&I funding.

Princeton University
Master in Public Policy
June 2019 - May 2020 (1 year)
Princeton, New Jersey

Additionally earned Science, Technology, and Environmental (STEP) Certificate. Areas of concentration include federal budgeting, Arctic policy and governance, technology policy, and national security.

Presidential Leadership Scholars
Presidential Leadership Scholars Class of 2019
January 2019 - July 2019 (7 months)

The Presidential Leadership Scholars program is a partnership among the Presidential Centers of George W. Bush, William J. Clinton, George H.W. Bush, and Lyndon B. Johnson and is designed for mid-career leaders from diverse backgrounds who share a commitment to helping solve society's greatest challenges. Participants connect with some of the best minds in the study of leadership and benefit from the assets of the Presidential Centers and the insights of former Presidents and the people who served with them. Http://www.presidentialleadershipscholars.org

U.S. Coast Guard
10 years 9 months

MH-60T Helicopter Deputy Operations and Security Officer
July 2016 - May 2019 (2 years 11 months)
USCG Air Station Kodiak, Alaska

MH-60 Helicopter Deputy Operations Officer. Responsible for Search and Rescue, Law Enforcement, and logistics missions across 4M square mile area of responsibility. Responsible for all training, operations, and physical and information security. Senior Instructor Pilot and Flight Examiner - leads, instructs, and evaluates 28 line pilots and 100+ aircrew and maintenance personnel. Oversees four forward operating locations across Alaska. Plans

and executes Operation America's Arctic Shield, the operational execution of USCG and US Government Arctic Strategy.

MH-60T Helicopter Flight Examiner and Government/External Affairs Officer
July 2012 - July 2016 (4 years 1 month)
USCG Air Station Clearwater, Florida

Lead Instructor Pilot and Flight Examiner. Oversaw all training and upgrades for largest fleet training program. Implemented new copilot onboarding and training system, which reduced upgrade time by 30%.

Government and External Affairs Officer: Oversaw all government, external, public, and media affairs. Managed crisis communications during major hurricane operations and the sinking of the El Faro cargo ship.

Helicopter Pilot and Flight Safety Officer
September 2008 - July 2012 (3 years 11 months)
USCG Air Station Elizabeth City, North Carolina

Conducted Search and Rescue operations across mid-Atlantic, including oceanic mission planning to Bermuda. Responded to BP Deepwater Horizon oil spill. MH-60J/T Aircraft Commander.

Flight Safety Officer: Oversaw all flight and ground mishap investigations, conducted mishap prevention, and reported lessons learned to decrease future mishap potential. Certified U.S. Navy Aviation Safety Officer, honor graduate. Southern California Safety Institute course certification: Human Factors Analysis, Safety Management Systems, Mishap Investigations.

U.S. Coast Guard
4 years 10 months

Deployable Team Leader- MSST Miami
May 2005 - September 2006 (1 year 5 months)
MSST Miami, Homestead Florida

Led 14 member team in high-risk operations. Conducted rescue and recovery efforts in New Orleans following Hurricane Katrina.

Surf Rescue Operations
December 2001 - May 2005 (3 years 6 months)

Western Parcel Express
No. California Sales Manager
January 2001 - December 2001 (1 year)

Education

NYU Stern School of Business

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Finance · (August 2022 - July 2024)

Princeton University

Masters, Public Policy · (2019 - 2020)

American Public University System

Master of Arts (MA), Political Science and Government · (2010 - 2012)

U.S. Naval War College

Joint Professional Military Education · (2016 - 2018)

University of Iowa

BA, Political Science · (1994 - 1998)